

CivicSign Launch Roadmap

Prepared 13 July 2026 · CivicBot LTD · UK e-signatures + Manage PDF

Executive summary: The product is **feature-complete for private beta**. You are approximately **2–3 weeks from private beta** and **5–6 weeks from public launch**, assuming focused execution on deploy, secrets, Stripe, and pilot onboarding.

~12 days

Private beta ready

~26 days

Soft public launch

~40 days

Full public launch

93/93

Backend tests pass

1. Where you are today (13 July 2026)

Area	Status	Evidence
Core signing flow	Ready	Register → upload → send → sign → complete E2E passes
Manage PDF (10 tools)	Ready	Compress, watermark, protect, unlock, merge, split, convert E2E
Marketing site	Ready	Landing, Pricing, Manage PDF product page, solutions, blog
Legal pages	Ready	Privacy, Terms, Cookies, Refunds — redesigned Jul 2026
Mobile UX	Ready	Header, legal, auth, marketing pages optimised for mobile
Security & privacy	Ready	Document encryption, staff cannot read PDFs, impersonation OTP
Org portal	Ready	Owner portal, team, contract tabs E2E
Admin console	Ready	Users, orgs, billing, audit, impersonation (consent-gated)
Backend API tests	Ready	93 passed, 1 skipped (live API integration)
Playwright E2E	Ready	12/12 specs pass locally
Smoke test	18/19	Seal verify lookup fails after fresh DB reset (data-dependent)
Production deploy	Pending	render.yaml ready; api.civicsign.co.uk not yet wired
Stripe live billing	Pending	Checkout works with test keys; live keys not configured
Secrets rotation	Required	Atlas, JWT, Resend keys should be rotated before prod

2. Launch timeline (recommended)

Phase 0 — Today → 14 Jul (1 day)

Freeze scope, tag release branch, run full test suite, export this roadmap.

Phase 1 — Pre-launch hardening (14 Jul → 18 Jul) — 4 working days

Rotate secrets, set `DOCUMENT_ENCRYPTION_KEY`, deploy API to Render, wire `api.civicsign.co.uk`, redeploy frontend with `REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL`.

Phase 2 — Private beta (19 Jul → 25 Jul) — 1 week

Onboard 5–10 pilot users (solicitors, agencies, freelancers). Founder-led support via `info@civicbot.co.uk`. Monitor health + errors daily.

Phase 3 — Billing go-live (21 Jul → 08 Aug) — 2.5 weeks

Stripe live keys, webhook on production URL, test Pro/Business checkout, refund policy in practice.

Phase 4 — Soft public launch (08 Aug) — target date

Remove private-beta banner, open self-serve registration, announce on LinkedIn / email list.

Phase 5 — Full public launch (22 Aug) — target date

Press/outreach, comparison content, SEO index, optional paid ads. SMS auth & Google OAuth remain post-launch.

3. Phase 1 — Pre-launch hardening (detailed checklist)

Day 1 — Secrets & keys (2–3 hours)

- Rotate MongoDB Atlas user password → update `MONGO_URL` in Render
- Generate new `JWT_SECRET`, `PLAN_ENCRYPTION_SECRET`, `DOCUMENT_ENCRYPTION_KEY` (32-byte base64)
- Rotate Resend API key; verify `SENDER_EMAIL=noreply@civicsign.co.uk`
- Never run `scripts/reset_dev_data.py` against production Atlas

Day 2 — Backend deploy (half day)

- Push `civicsign-2026-overhaul` branch to GitHub
- Render Dashboard → New → Blueprint → select repo (reads `render.yaml`)
- Set all `sync: false` env vars in Render dashboard
- Confirm `https://<render-url>/api/health` returns 200
- Add custom domain `api.civicsign.co.uk` (CNAME in Cloudflare, grey cloud initially)

Day 3 — Frontend deploy (2 hours)

- Cloudflare Pages: `REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL=https://api.civicsign.co.uk`
- Optional beta flag: `REACT_APP_PRIVATE_BETA=true`
- Trigger frontend rebuild + purge Cloudflare cache
- Verify login, register, dashboard, manage-pdf on production URL

Day 4 — Verification (2 hours)

- Run `REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL=https://api.civicsign.co.uk python3 scripts/smoke_test.py`
- Manual: register → verify email → upload PDF → send → sign → download → seal verify
- Set up UptimeRobot on `/api/health` (5-min interval, free tier)
- Lock Atlas Network Access to Render outbound IPs

4. Phase 2 — Private beta (5–10 pilots)

Task	Owner	Duration
Identify 5–10 pilot organisations (legal, HR, property, freelancers)	Founder	2 days
Send onboarding email with register link + support contact	Founder	1 day
Create org accounts in admin for enterprise-style pilots (optional)	Founder	As needed
Daily inbox check + 24h response SLA	Founder	Ongoing
Collect feedback: signing UX, PDF tools, pricing, mobile	Founder	Weekly call
Fix P0 bugs from pilots within 48h	Dev	Ongoing
Track metrics: signups, envelopes sent, completion rate, churn signals	Founder	Weekly

Beta success criteria: 3+ pilots complete a full signing cycle without founder intervention; zero data-loss incidents; <2 P0 bugs open at end of beta.

5. Phase 3 — Stripe billing go-live

- Create Stripe live mode products for Pro (£15/mo) and Business (£79/mo) — prices excl. VAT
- Set `STRIPE_API_KEY` and `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` in Render
- Webhook endpoint: `https://api.civicsign.co.uk/api/webhook/stripe`
- Test: Free user upgrades to Pro → payment → plan updates → quota increases
- Test: Pay-as-you-go extra document purchase (80p excl. VAT)
- Document refund process per `/legal/refunds` policy

6. Phase 4 — Soft public launch (08 August 2026 target)

- Remove `REACT_APP_PRIVATE_BETA` banner from frontend build
- Publish blog post: "CivicSign is live — UK-built e-signatures"
- Update sitemap; submit to Google Search Console
- LinkedIn announcement + email to waitlist
- Monitor signup funnel, error rates, and support volume for 7 days

7. Phase 5 — Full public launch (22 August 2026 target)

- Industry landing pages SEO pass (solutions/*)
- Case study from best beta pilot
- Optional: Product Hunt, legal tech directories, ICAEW/Law Society outreach
- Consider SOC2 / Cyber Essentials roadmap (Q4 2026) for enterprise sales

8. Post-launch backlog (defer until after launch)

Feature	Priority	Notes
SMS signer authentication	P2	Not required for UK solicitor workflows initially
Google OAuth sign-in	P2	Email/password works; add when demand confirmed
Cookie-only auth (remove JWT from login JSON)	P2	Security hardening per SECURITY-NOTES.md
Bundle size / code splitting	P3	710KB gzip main bundle — optimise after launch
Legacy PDF encryption migration	P3	Re-upload old GridFS docs if any exist in prod

9. Risk register

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Secrets exposed in dev transcripts	High	Rotate all keys before prod deploy (Phase 1 Day 1)
Render cold start on free tier	High	Use starter plan (\$7/mo) — already in render.yaml
Stripe webhook failures	Medium	Test webhook in staging; monitor Stripe dashboard
Email deliverability	Medium	Resend domain verified; SPF/DKIM on civicsign.co.uk
Founder support overload	Medium	Cap beta at 10 users; template FAQ responses
Legal/regulatory challenge	Low	UK eIDAS aligned; audit trail + Certificate of Completion

10. Weekly work plan (next 4 weeks)

Week	Dates	Focus	Deliverable
Week 1	14–18 Jul	Deploy + verify	api.civicsign.co.uk live, smoke test on prod
Week 2	21–25 Jul	Private beta	5 pilots onboarded, feedback doc
Week 3	28 Jul – 1 Aug	Beta fixes + Stripe	Live billing, beta bugs closed
Week 4	4–8 Aug	Soft launch prep	Marketing assets, launch checklist signed off

11. Key commands & paths

- Local dev: `make dev-all` → `http://localhost:3000`
- Full test: `make test-all` + `make test-e2e`

- Prod smoke: `REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL=https://api.civicsign.co.uk python3 scripts/smoke_test.py`
- Deploy guide: `DEPLOYMENT.md`
- Security audit: `SECURITY-NOTES.md`
- GitHub: [marvin2013charlie-sys/civicsign1.1.1.1](#) (branch: civicsign-2026-overhaul)